too early for de-mining as many businesses are entering these areas."[15] Ceasefires are exposing communities to new and perhaps more serious threats than those they encountered previously. In response, communities continue to resort to protection strategies that include the use of landmines to contain outside encroachment and protect their assets.

## INFORMATION SHARING ABOUT LANDMINE USE

Stakeholders and respondents at all levels often spoke of landmines being a "sensitive issue". This sensitivity is partly associated with the fear of negative consequences for sharing information regarding the whereabouts and types of landmines. That is, villagers fear that individuals, families, and communities might be targeted for interrogation or be more exposed to human rights violations if they are identified as having knowledge of, or involvement with, explosive devices. Consequently, people keep quiet about their knowledge, as exemplified in statements during interviews like, "I did not dare to talk about this to anyone because I was worried… I might get… trouble", and, "I have never told about this to anyone. I am able to talk about this only when you came".[16]

Internally displaced populations in Kachin and northern Shan States show an even higher level of sensitivity than others, with just over one quarter of respondents in these locations stating they would not talk about an explosive device they had seen (MRE WG 2015).

Despite this fear of reporting to others, more than two-thirds of men and women stated they knew what landmines were. But when these respondents were asked to list their sources of information, nearly half chose not to respond and a third responded 'don't know' (MRE WG 2014).

Community protection strategies aim to promote survival, and the chances of survival are improved if silence is kept regarding landmines and their locations. Communities thereby retain local knowledge, giving them more power in their relations with belligerent patrons and other outsiders. For instance, one informant spoke of an EAG member being injured from landmines set by local communities. The EAG then came to the village and implored the community that "they did not want to harm them, but to just tell where the landmines were".[17]

Information is shared predominantly through person-to-person contact. Nearly a quarter (twenty-three per cent) of all households reported